

ENG507 SHORT HANDOUTS

MIDTERM

Lesson 06 to 10

(ENG507) Phonetics and Phonology

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Lesson-06

ARTICULATORY PHONETICS-III

Topic-032: The Waveforms of Consonants

What can you observe in the waveform that distinguishes stop, nasal, fricative, and approximant consonants?

Differences in the waveform pattern, closure, burst, and voicing.

How can you differentiate between voiced and voiceless sounds in the waveform?

Voiced sounds produce voicing vibrations in the waveform, whereas voiceless sounds have a flat line.

Topic-033: The Articulation of Vowel Sounds

What distinguishes vowels from consonants in terms of articulation?

Vowels have no complete closure or audible friction, allowing air to escape evenly over the center of the tongue.

What are some properties that distinguish one vowel from another?

Lip shape (rounded, neutral, or spread), tongue position (front, middle, or back), and tongue height.

How do vowels differ from consonants in terms of articulation, as explained?

It is elucidated that vowels and consonants differ in their articulation. Vowels are characterized by the absence of complete closure in the mouth and the lack of audible friction. Air flows evenly over the center of the tongue during vowel articulation. Vowels are also typically found at the center of a syllable and are rarely able to stand alone as a whole syllable. To distinguish one vowel from another, phonetics considers properties such as lip shape (rounded, neutral, or spread) and tongue position (front, middle, or back).

Topic-034: The Sounds of Vowels

How can vowels be defined phonetically?

Vowels are sounds without complete mouth closure or audible friction, with air escaping over the center of the tongue.

What are the key acoustic features used to distinguish vowels?

Formant frequencies F1 and F2, with F1 related to vowel height and F2 related to front or back vowel qualities.

Topic-035: Long Vowels and Diphthongs

What is the significance of long vowels in some languages?

Long vowels can create phonemic distinctions between short and long vowel sounds, impacting stress patterns.

What characterizes a diphthong, and how many are found in BBC English?

A diphthong contains a glide from one vowel quality to another. BBC English has eight diphthongs.

What is the significance of long vowels in some languages, as discussed?

Topic-035 emphasizes that long vowels, often transcribed with the diacritic [:], hold significance in certain languages. These long vowels create a contrast of length, distinguishing them from their short counterparts. This length distinction is important in speech, with stressed syllables typically being longer than unstressed ones. Some languages, like English, have phonemic differences between short and long vowels, contrasting short vowels (e.g., i, e, ʊ, ʌ) with long vowels (e.g., i:, e:, u:, ɜ:).

ɑ:, ɔ:, u:, ɜ:). Additionally, diphthongs are introduced as vowel combinations characterized by a glide from one vowel quality to another.

Topic-036: Introduction to Suprasegmental

What does 'suprasegmental' refer to in phonetics?

'Suprasegmental' refers to aspects of sound like intonation, which go beyond individual speech segments (vowels and consonants).

What are some commonly mentioned suprasegmental features in speech?

Pitch, loudness, tempo, juncture, syllable, rhythm, and stress.

Lesson-07

PHONEMIC AND PHONETIC TRANSCRIPTION-I

Topic-037: Why Transcribe?

What is transcription in phonetics and phonology?

Transcription is the writing down of a spoken utterance using specific symbols.

Why is transcription important in phonetics, and what is the difference between phonemic and phonetic transcription?

Transcription is vital for representing spoken language. It can be divided into phonemic, where only symbols for phonemes are used, and phonetic, which provides more detailed information about sounds.

Topic-038: Introduction to IPA

What is the IPA (International Phonetic Association), and when was it established?

The IPA, established in 1886, is a forum that uses phonetics to enhance foreign language teaching.

How did the IPA influence language teaching, and how does it contribute to phonetic study today?

The IPA revolutionized language teaching, shifting focus from written language to spoken language proficiency. Today, it provides tools for phonetic study and maintains a set of alphabets for transcription.

Topic-039: Explaining IPA Chart

What is the purpose of the IPA charts, and when was the last revision done?

The IPA charts serve to transcribe both segments and phonetic variation, with the last revision in 2015.

How does the IPA chart help in transcribing phonetic details, and when was the most recent revision made?

The IPA chart aids in transcribing segments and detailed phonetic variations. The last revision took place in 2015.

Topic-040: Transcription of Vowels

What is essential to learn the transcription of vowels, and how many short vowels, long vowels, and diphthongs are there in BBC English?

To learn vowel transcription, start with the IPA chart and note that BBC English has seven short vowels, five long vowels, and eight diphthongs.

Explain the process of learning vowel transcription, and provide examples of short vowels, long vowels, and diphthongs in BBC English.

To learn vowel transcription, first explore the IPA chart. BBC English has seven short vowels (e.g., ɪ), five long vowels (e.g., i:), and eight diphthongs (e.g., eɪ).

Topic-041: Transcription of Consonants

What chart can be used to transcribe consonant sounds, and how many symbols are there for consonants in BBC English?

The IPA chart is used for transcribing consonant sounds, and there are 24 symbols for consonants in BBC English.

Explain how to transcribe consonant sounds using the IPA chart and provide examples of different consonant types in BBC English.

You can use the IPA chart for transcribing consonant sounds. In BBC English, there are plosives (e.g., p, b), affricates (e.g., tʃ, dʒ), fricatives (e.g., f, v), nasals (e.g., m, n), and approximants (e.g., l, r).

Topic-042: Transcription of Consonants: Explanation

Can you provide examples of plosive, affricate, fricative, nasal, and approximant consonants in English?

Examples of plosive include 'p' and 'b,' affricate 'tʃ' and 'dʒ,' fricative 'f' and 'v,' nasal 'm' and 'n,' and approximant 'l' and 'r.'

Provide examples and explanations for each type of consonant (plosive, affricate, fricative, nasal, and approximant) in the English language.

Plosives, like 'p' and 'b,' are produced by stopping and releasing airflow. Affricates, such as 'tʃ' and 'dʒ,' combine plosive and fricative elements. Fricatives, like 'f' and

'v,' involve the narrowing of airflow. Nasals, e.g., 'm' and 'n,' result from airflow through the nose. Approximants, such as 'l' and 'r,' are produced with slight constriction.

Lesson-08

PHONEMIC AND PHONETIC TRANSCRIPTION-II

Topic-043: Broad and Narrow Transcription

What are the two main kinds of transcription?

Broad (phonemic) and narrow (phonetic).

How is phonemic transcription represented?

Phonemic transcription is enclosed in oblique lines or slashes, e.g., /pin/.

What's the focus of narrow transcription?

Narrow transcription symbolizes sounds based on their articulatory/auditory identity, not their linguistic function.

Explain the difference between broad (phonemic) and narrow (phonetic) transcription, and provide examples for each.

Broad transcription focuses on representing sounds based on their linguistic functions without detailing physical features. For example, /pin/, /pen/, /pæn/ are broad transcriptions. Narrow transcription, on the other hand, captures sounds based on their articulatory/auditory identity, providing a detailed description of individual sounds. For instance, [ðə 'nɔ:ɪθ ,wɪnd ən ə 'sʌn wə ɹɪs'pjʊ:ɪŋ] is a narrow transcription of the same text.

Topic-044: IPA Resource: The North Wind and the Sun Story

Where can you find 'The North Wind and the Sun' story for transcription?

The story is available on the International Phonetics Association (IPA) website.

Topic-045: IPA Resource: Explanation

What is the story that students are required to transcribe?

The story is 'The North Wind and the Sun,' where a traveler is asked to remove his cloak.

Provide an overview of 'The North Wind and the Sun' story. Why is this story recommended for transcription, and what is the challenge presented in the story?

'The North Wind and the Sun' story involves a traveler asked to remove his cloak, with the North Wind and the Sun attempting to make him do so. This story is recommended for transcription to create a uniform system for describing the sounds of languages, both in narrow and broad transcription. The challenge in the story lies in understanding and transcribing the phonetic and phonemic features, as well as the nuances in pronunciation that affect the meaning.

Topic-046: IPA Story Practice

Which symbols are used to transcribe the story in the BBC accent of English?

Vowels and consonants symbols listed in Topic 46 are used for transcription.

Topic-047: IPA Story: Broad Transcription

How do you phonemically transcribe the story?

Use oblique lines/slashes for phonemic transcription, representing only linguistic differences without detailing physical features.

Topic-048: IPA Story-Phonetic Transcription

How do you perform phonetic transcription of the story?

Use square brackets and provide detailed articulatory/auditory features, including diacritics and IPA symbols.

Lesson-08

PHONEMIC AND PHONETIC TRANSCRIPTION-II

Topic-043: Broad and Narrow Transcription

What are the two main kinds of transcription recognized in linguistics?

Broad transcription, sometimes known as phonemic transcription, symbolized within oblique lines.

Narrow transcription, also called phonetic transcription, enclosed within square brackets.

What is the focus of broad transcription?

Representing sounds based on their linguistic functions without detailing their physical features.

What is the primary aim of narrow transcription?

Symbolizing sounds based on their articulatory and auditory identity, making subtle distinctions between sounds.

Topic-044: IPA Resource: The North Wind and the Sun Story

What is 'The North Wind and the Sun' story used for in the context of phonetic transcription?

It is recommended for both narrow and broad transcription, especially for publishing the IPA illustrations of languages in the IPA journal.

Where can you find resources related to the International Phonetics Association (IPA)?

The home page of the International Phonetics Association (The IPA) at <https://www.internationalphoneticassociation.org/>.

Topic-045: IPA Resource: Explanation

What are the North Wind and the Sun disputing in the story?

They are disputing which one is stronger.

How do they decide who is stronger in the story?

They agree that the one who makes the traveler take off his cloak first is considered stronger.

What happens when the North Wind blows in the story?

The traveler wraps his cloak more closely around him.

When does the traveler take off his cloak in the story?

The traveler takes off his cloak when the sun shines warmly.

Topic-046: IPA Story Practice

Which symbols are used for transcribing the 'The North Wind and the Sun' story in BBC English?

Vowels: ɪ, e, æ, ʌ, ɒ, ʊ, ə, ɐ, iː, ɑː, ɔː, uː, ɜː

Consonants: p, b, t, d, k, g, f, v, θ, ð, s, z, ʃ, ʒ, h, m, n, ŋ, l, r, w, j, ʧ, ʤ

Topic-047: IPA Story: Broad Transcription

How should you transcribe 'The North Wind and the Sun' story phonemically?

Use oblique lines/slashes at the beginning and ending of the transcription (enclosing phonemic transcription).

Transcribe broadly without going into the detail of the physical features (phonetic) of individual sounds.

Provide an example of phonemic transcription for the first sentence of the story.

/ðə nɒrθ wɪnd ən ðə sʌn wəz dɪspjuːtɪŋ/

Topic-048: IPA Story-Phonetic Transcription

What is the primary objective of narrow or phonetic transcription?

Giving a detailed account of individual sounds based on their articulatory and auditory features.

How are sounds enclosed in narrow transcription?

They are enclosed within square brackets, such as [k].

How is the sentence 'The North Wind and the Sun' transcribed in narrow transcription?

[ðə 'nɒrθ ,wɪnd ən ə 'sʌn wəz dɪs'pjʊːtɪŋ]

Lesson-09

PHONEMIC AND PHONETIC TRANSCRIPTION-III

Topic-049: Transcription Beyond Words

What is the focus of transcription beyond words in phonetics?

It focuses on the features of connected speech, known as suprasegmental features, in continuous utterances and conversations.

What are some features of connected speech?

Assimilation, rhythm, stress, elision, linking, tone, and intonation.

Topic-050: Transcription Beyond Words: Word Stress

How is stress defined in phonetics?

Stress refers to the degree of force used in producing a syllable, with stressed syllables being more prominent than unstressed ones.

What symbol is used to mark primary stress in transcription?

The symbol ['] is used above the line before the stressed syllable.

How is secondary stress marked in transcription?

The symbol [ˌ] is used below the line before the stressed syllable.

Topic-051: Transcription Beyond Words: Accent

How does accent relate to the way language is pronounced in various English varieties?

Accent reflects the specific features in pronunciation that identify regional or national varieties of a language, such as BBC, American, or Chinese English.

What are the four types of variations that must be considered when transcribing for a specific accent?

- a. Difference in phonological inventories.
- b. Difference in phonetic features.
- c. Phonological distribution.
- d. Lexical distribution.

Topic-052: Transcription Beyond Words: Phrases

What is the term for changes in pronunciation that occur when words are put together in phrases in connected speech?

Assimilation, elision, linking, epenthesis, and liaison.

Provide an example of assimilation in connected speech.

The /n/ in "ten" changes to /ŋ/ in anticipation of its contact with the /g/ in "green."

Topic-053: Transcription Beyond Words: Rhythm and Beyond

What aspects of rhythm and connected speech need to be considered when transcribing?

Patterns of stressed vs. unstressed syllables, syllable length, pitch, and their combinations.

What is a maximally regular pattern in connected speech, often encountered in poetry?

'Metrical' patterns.

Analyze the following poem in terms of rhythmic and other features: "Ten green bottles Hanging on the wall / And if one green bottle Should accidentally fall / There'd be nine green bottles Hanging on the wall."

Lesson-10

THE CONSONANTS OF ENGLISH-I

Topic-054: The Consonants of English

How many consonants are there in the RP accent of English?

There are 24 consonants.

How are these consonants described?

They are described in terms of voicing, manner of articulation, and place of articulation.

In the description of these consonants, what distinguishes the voiced and voiceless sounds?

Consonants on the right side of the column are voiced, and those on the left are voiceless.

Topic-055: Stop Consonants

What are stop consonants also known as?

Stop consonants are often referred to as plosives.

How many stops are there in English, and how are they further categorized?

English has nine stops: six oral and three nasal stops. They are categorized into bilabial, alveolar, and velar stops.

Can you provide an example of a voiced stop consonant and its place of articulation?

Example: [b] is a voiced bilabial stop.

What is the term for the aspiration of English voiceless stops at the beginning of words?

The term is aspiration, and it occurs in words like [phaI, thaI, khaI].

Topic-056: Fricatives

How are fricatives characterized in terms of articulation?

Fricatives are characterized by articulators coming close enough to create audible friction, but there is no complete closure.

Can you name some voiced and voiceless fricatives in BBC English?

Voiced fricatives: [v], [ð], [z], [ʒ].

Voiceless fricatives: [f], [θ], [s], [ʃ], [h].

What is the distinction between fortis and lenis fricatives in English?

Fortis fricatives: [f], [s], [θ], [ʃ], [h].

Lenis fricatives: [v], [z], [ð], [ʒ].

What term describes the grouping of stops and fricatives in phonetics?

Stops and fricatives together are called "obstruents."

Topic-057: Affricates

What is an affricate sound in phonetics?

An affricate is a consonant made of a plosive followed by a fricative with the same place of articulation.

Can you provide examples of English affricates?

English has two affricates: /tʃ/ (voiceless) and /dʒ/ (voiced).

Topic-058: Nasals

How are nasals produced, and what are the articulatory actions involved?

Nasals are produced when the soft palate (velum) is lowered to allow air to escape through the nose, while a closure is made in the oral tract.

What are the three common voiced nasal sounds in English?

/m/ (bilabial), /n/ (alveolar), and /ŋ/ (velar).

Topic-059: Approximants

What are approximants in phonetics, and how are they divided into groups?

Approximants are consonants with minimal obstruction to airflow. They are divided into semivowels and liquids.

Can you provide examples of approximants in BBC English?

Bilabial: /w/ (e.g., "whack").

Alveolar: /l/ (e.g., "lack") and /r/ (e.g., "rack").

Palatal: /j/ (e.g., "yak").

In what situations might experts differentiate among various kinds of /r/ approximants?

Experts may differentiate among tap, flap, and trill /r/ approximants in specific phonetic contexts.

Working on the Next Lessons

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